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Report: Week 3

Week 3-6 goals (per proposal):

- Development of models outlined in Technical Approach
- Drafting introduction and initial findings of paper

Accomplishments

Data Collecting and Cleaning:

- Last week, I started an approach of identifying relevant variables based on Grawe's work. This week, I started collecting as much valid and reliable data as I could find that can be used to construct those variables.
- I constructed two datasets: (1) with data regarding closed colleges and their characteristics, and (2) with state-level data on birth rates, unemployment rates, economic indicators, and relevant data regarding higher education.
- Over the weekend I'm planning on finishing up collecting data grouped by race and gender in the state level, which will be helpful for analysis.
- After both datasets are complete I'll merge them into one containing only dummy variables to be ready for any type of modeling.

Statistical Analysis:

- Although behind schedule, I have not done any particular statistical analysis yet, as I've felt that the data was not complete.
- In the process however, I've done some minor EDA to understand certain relationships better and to identify potential hypotheses to test later on.

Literature Review:

- As I am browsing different sources for new data (almost all governmental agencies), they are being added to the bibliography.